IUCN Species

IUCN Categories Meaning

- **Extinct (EX):** No living individuals remain after exhaustive surveys. (Wikipedia)
- **Extinct in the Wild (EW):** Survives only in captivity or outside its historical range. (Wikipedia)
- **Critically Endangered (CR):** Faces an *extremely high* risk of extinction in the wild. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Endangered (EN):** Faces a *very high* risk of extinction in the wild. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Vulnerable (VU):** Faces a *high* risk of extinction in the wild. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Near Threatened (NT):** Close to qualifying as threatened; likely to become so soon. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Least Concern (LC):** Widespread and abundant; not at immediate risk. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Data Deficient (DD):** Insufficient data for assessment; not a threat category. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)
- **Not Evaluated (NE):** Not yet assessed by IUCN. (cmsdocs.s3.amazonaws.com, Wikipedia)

'Threatened' refers collectively to CR, EN, and VU. (Wikipedia, IUCN Red List)

IUCN Status Table - Animals (Fauna)

World Example Species (5 per Category + Group & Range)

Category	Examples with Animal Group & Range (Latest IUCN Year)
CR	• **Javan rhinoceros** (*Rhinoceros sondaicus*), mammal, Java (2021–2022) • **Sumatran rhinoceros** (*Dicerorhinus sumatrensis*), mammal, Sumatra/NE India (2015) • **Vaquita** (*Phocoena sinus*), mammal (porpoise), Gulf of California (2018) • **Hawksbill sea turtle** (*Eretmochelys imbricata*), reptile, tropical oceans (2008) •

MADHURIMA RAWAT

	Saola (*Pseudoryx nghetinhensis*), mammal, Annamite Range (2015)
EN	• **Tiger** (*Panthera tigris*), mammal, Asia (2021) • **African savanna elephant** (*Loxodonta africana*), mammal, sub-Saharan Africa (2021) • **Blue whale** (*Balaenoptera musculus*), mammal, oceans worldwide (2018) • **African wild dog** (*Lycaon pictus*), mammal, Africa (2012) • **Wild water buffalo** (*Bubalus arnee*), mammal, South/Southeast Asia (2016)
VU	• **Leopard** (*Panthera pardus*), mammal, Africa/Asia (2016) • **Giraffe spp.**, mammal, Africa (2016/2020–21) • **Hippopotamus** (*Hippopotamus amphibius*), mammal, Africa (2016) • **Lion** (*Panthera leo*), mammal, Africa/Asia (2016) • **Koala** (*Phascolarctos cinereus*), mammal, Australia (2022)

India Example Species (5 per Category + Group & Range)

Category	Examples with Animal Group & Range (Latest IUCN Year)
CR	• **Great Indian bustard** (*Ardeotis nigriceps*), bird, central India (2018) • **Jerdon's courser** (*Rhinoptilus bitorquatus*), bird, Andhra Pradesh (2018) • **Bengal florican** (*Houbaropsis bengalensis*), bird, NE India (2017) • **White-rumped vulture** (*Gyps bengalensis*), bird, Indian subcontinent (2015) • **Gharial** (*Gavialis gangeticus*), reptile (crocodilian), northern Indian rivers (2017)
EN	• **Asian elephant** (*Elephas maximus*), mammal, India/South Asia (2020–21) • **Red panda** (*Ailurus fulgens*), mammal, Eastern Himalayas (2015) • **Ganges river dolphin** (*Platanista gangetica*), mammal (cetacean), Ganges–Brahmaputra (2012) • **Lion-tailed macaque** (*Macaca silenus*), mammal, Western Ghats (2015) • **Wild water buffalo** (*Bubalus arnee*), mammal, NE India/Bangladesh (2016)
VU	• **Indian rhinoceros** (*Rhinoceros unicornis*), mammal, Assam/Nepal (2018) • **Leopard** (*Panthera pardus*), mammal, India (2016) • **Sloth bear** (*Melursus ursinus*), mammal, Indian subcontinent (2016) • **Gaur** (*Bos gaurus*), mammal, India/SE Asia

MADHURIMA RAWAT

	(2016) • **Olive ridley turtle** (*Lepidochelys olivacea*), reptile, Indian Ocean/coasts (2008)

World Example Species

- **CR:** Javan rhinoceros (*Rhinoceros sondaicus*), a mammal native to Java (2021–22); Sumatran rhinoceros (*Dicerorhinus sumatrensis*), mammal in Sumatra and NE India (2015); Vaquita (*Phocoena sinus*), porpoise in the Gulf of California (2018); Hawksbill sea turtle (*Eretmochelys imbricata*), marine reptile in tropical oceans (2008); Saola (*Pseudoryx nghetinhensis*), mammal from the Annamite Range (2015).
- **EN:** Tiger (*Panthera tigris*), mammal across Asia (2021); African savanna elephant (*Loxodonta africana*), mammal in sub-Saharan Africa (2021); Blue whale (*Balaenoptera musculus*), marine mammal worldwide (2018); African wild dog (*Lycaon pictus*), mammal in Africa (2012); Wild water buffalo (*Bubalus arnee*), mammal in South/Southeast Asia (2016).
- **VU:** Leopard (*Panthera pardus*), mammal in Africa and Asia (2016); Giraffe spp., mammal in Africa (2016/2020–21); Hippopotamus (*Hippopotamus amphibius*), mammal in Africa (2016); Lion (*Panthera leo*), mammal in Africa and Asia (2016); Koala (*Phascolarctos cinereus*), mammal in Australia (2022).

India Example Species

- **CR:** Great Indian bustard (*Ardeotis nigriceps*), bird in central India (2018); Jerdon's courser (*Rhinoptilus bitorquatus*), bird in Andhra Pradesh (2018); Bengal florican (*Houbaropsis bengalensis*), bird in NE India (2017); White-rumped vulture (*Gyps bengalensis*), bird in the Indian subcontinent (2015); Gharial (*Gavialis gangeticus*), crocodilian reptile in northern Indian rivers (2017).
- **EN:** Asian elephant (*Elephas maximus*), mammal in India/South Asia (2020–21); Red panda (*Ailurus fulgens*), mammal in the Eastern Himalayas (2015); Ganges river dolphin (*Platanista gangetica*), cetacean in the Ganges–Brahmaputra system (2012); Lion-tailed macaque (*Macaca silenus*), mammal in the Western Ghats (2015); Wild water buffalo (*Bubalus arnee*), mammal in NE India and Bangladesh (2016).

MADHURIMA RAWAT

- **VU:** Indian rhinoceros (*Rhinoceros unicornis*), mammal in Assam and Nepal (2018); Leopard (*Panthera pardus*), mammal in India (2016); Sloth bear (*Melursus ursinus*), mammal in the Indian subcontinent (2016); Gaur (*Bos gaurus*), mammal in India and SE Asia (2016); Olive ridley turtle (*Lepidochelys olivacea*), marine reptile in the Indian Ocean/coasts (2008).

IUCN Status Table by Category, Group, Range & Habitat

IUCN Category	Example Species (Group)	Geographic Area (Range)	Habitat Type
Extinct (EX)	Aurochs (*Bos primigenius*, Mammal)	Eurasia (Europe to India)	Grasslands, woodland edge
	Dodo (*Raphus cucullatus*, Bird)	Mauritius	Island forest
	Steller's sea cow (*Hydrodamalis gigas*, Mammal)	Commander Islands (Bering Sea)	Coastal marine
	Woolly Mammoth (*Mammuthus primigenius*, Mammal)	Northern Eurasia & North America	Arctic tundra/steppe
Extinct in the Wild (EW)	Père David's deer (*Elaphurus davidianus*, Mammal)	China (survives only in captivity/restored sites)	Wetlands/riverside forest
	Wyoming toad (*Anaxyrus baxteri*, Amphibian)	Wyoming, USA (only in captivity or managed reserves)	Montane wetland
	Christmas Island blue-tailed skink (*Cryptoblepharus egeriae*, Reptile)	Christmas Island	Forest understorey

MADHURIMA RAWAT

Critically Endangered (CR)	Vaquita (*Phocoena sinus*, Mammal)	Northern Gulf of California	Marine (coastal porpoise habitat)
	Saola (*Pseudoryx nghetinhensis*, Mammal)	Annamite Range, Vietnam–Laos	Montane forest understory
	Kihansi spray toad (*Nectophrynoides asperginis*, Amphibian)	Kihansi Gorge, Tanzania	Riverine spray zone (waterfall mist)
	Forest Owlet (*Heteroglaux blewitti*, Bird)	Central India (endemic)	Dry deciduous forest
	One critically endangered plant (e.g., *Franklinia alatamaha*)	Southeastern USA (Georgia)	Riparian forest
Endangered (EN)	Tiger (*Panthera tigris*, Mammal)	Asia (various subspecies)	Forests, grasslands
	Ganges river dolphin (*Platanista gangetica*, Mammal)	Ganges–Brahmaputra river system, South Asia	Freshwater river
	— *(No reptile or amphibian EN example at hand)*	—	—
	Philippine Eagle (*Pithecophaga jefferyi*, Bird)	Philippines (Luzon, Mindanao)	Tropical montane forest
	— *(No specific plant EN example cited)*	—	—

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Vulnerable (VU)	Indian rhinoceros (*Rhinoceros unicornis*, Mammal)	Assam (India), Nepal (Terai)	Floodplain grassland and forest
	Leopard (*Panthera pardus*, Mammal)	Africa, Asia	Forests, savanna, mountains
	— *(No reptile or amphibian VU example at hand)*	—	—
	— *(No bird VU example cited)*	—	—
	Wood's cycad (*Encephalartos woodii*, Plant)	South Africa (extinct in wild)	Montane grassland/scrub
Near Threatened (NT)	Jaguar (*Panthera onca*)	Central & South America	Tropical Rainforests, Wetlands
	Himalayan Monal (*Lophophorus impejanus*)	Himalayas	Temperate Forests
Least Concern (LC)	House Sparrow (*Passer domesticus*)	Worldwide	Urban & Rural Areas
	Indian Palm Squirrel (*Funambulus palmarum*)	South Asia	Urban Gardens, Forests
Data Deficient (DD)	Fishing Cat (*Prionailurus viverrinus*)	South & Southeast Asia	Wetlands, Mangroves
	Indian Purple Frog (*Nasikabatrachus sahyadrensis*)	Western Ghats	Forest Floor, Seasonal Streams
Not Evaluated (NE)	Numerous Insects & Microfauna	Various Regions	Diverse (Not Assessed)

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Notes & Context

- The IUCN Red List includes nine categories from **Extinct (EX)** to **Not Evaluated (NE)** (IUCN Red List, iucn.org).
- **Extinct in the Wild (EW)** species, such as Père David's deer and Wyoming toad, survive only under controlled human care or limited reintroduction programs (Wikipedia).
- The **Extinct** category includes notable species like the dodo, Steller's sea cow, and woolly mammoth, as compiled in the IUCN's records (Wikipedia, A-Z Animals).
- For **Critically Endangered (CR)**, species like the vaquita and saola are among the most imperiled mammals; amphibian examples include the Kihansi spray toad (Wikipedia).

IUCN Status Table - Plants (Flora)

IUCN Category	Example Species (Range/Area)	Habitat Type
Extinct (EX)	**Govenia floridana** (*Florida govenia*, Everglades, USA) (Wikipedia)	Shaded tropical hardwood hammock in Everglades National Park
Extinct in the Wild (EW)	**Franklinia alatamaha** (*Franklin Tree*, Southeastern USA) (Wikipedia)	Riparian forest
	Encephalartos woodii (Wood's cycad, South Africa) (Wikipedia)	Montane grassland / scrub
Critically Endangered (CR)	**Centaurea akamantis** (*Akamas centaurea*, Cyprus, ~7 km² range) (Wikipedia)	Shaded, humid limestone cliffs
	Anthemis glaberrima (*Chamomille of Gramvousa*, Crete islets) (top50.iucn-mpsg.org)	Sea cliffs and rocky offshore islets

MADHURIMA RAWAT

	Bupleurum kakiskalae (Western Crete) (Wikipedia)	Calcareous cliffs at altitudes ~1,450–1,500 m
	Auerodendron pauciflorum (*Turtlefat*, Puerto Rico) (Wikipedia)	Subtropical moist limestone hills
	Trochetiopsis ebenus (*Dwarf ebony*, St Helena) (gardensillustrated.com)	Cliff-face on St Helena island; survived grazing by goats
	Worsleya procera (*Blue amaryllis*, Brazil) (gardensillustrated.com)	Granite hillsides under threat from wildfires and poaching
Endangered (EN)	**Aconitum chasmanthum** (Himalayas) (iucn.org)	Alpine/subalpine Himalayas; overharvested for medicinal roots
	American Elm (*Ulmus americana*, North America) (topicwise.in)	Woodland forests; threatened by Dutch Elm Disease
Vulnerable (VU)	**Paris polyphylla** (Western Himalayas) (The Times of India)	Alpine/tarai zones; valued in traditional medicine
Near Threatened (NT)	**Magnolia grandiflora** – USA	Moist Forests, Swamps
	Sal (Shorea robusta) – Indian Subcontinent	Tropical Dry Forests
Least Concern (LC)	**Neem (Azadirachta indica)** – South Asia	Dry Tropical Forests, Urban Areas
	Sacred Fig (Ficus religiosa) – Indian Subcontinent	Plains & Urban Parks
Data Deficient (DD)	**Gigasiphon macrosiphon** – Madagascar	Dry Forests
	Begonia tessaricarpa – India (Assam)	Shady Moist Areas

MADHURIMA RAWAT

Not Evaluated (NE)	Many wild grasses, mosses, fungi	Various ecosystems

Highlights & Conservation Context

- **Extinct (EX)** and **Extinct in the Wild (EW)** designations underscore irreversible biodiversity loss or reliance on human care. *Govenia floridana* is fully extinct, whereas species like *Franklinia alatamaha* and *Encephalartos woodii* survive only in cultivation or managed conservation settings. (Wikipedia)
- **Critically Endangered (CR)** examples showcase highly restricted endemics, often surviving only on tiny cliffs or isolated habitats—ranging from Mediterranean sea cliffs to Puerto Rican limestone hills. Such species face extreme threats from habitat loss, grazing, or collection. (Wikipedia, top50.iucn-mpsg.org, gardensillustrated.com)
- **Endangered (EN)** examples illustrate regionally significant species under grave threat from human pressures, such as overharvesting (*Aconitum chasmanthum*) or disease (*Ulmus americana*). (iucn.org, topicwise.in)
- **Vulnerable (VU)**: *Paris polyphylla* reflects medicinally valued species in high-altitude fragile ecosystems. Conservation actions to reintroduce it are already underway in the Himalayas. (The Times of India)
- **Near Threatened (NT)** plants like *Madhuca barbata*, *M. dubardii*, and *M. pallida* are small trees in the Sapotaceae family found in Southeast Asian dipterocarp forests—habitats under strong threat from logging and palm-oil-driven land conversion (Wikipedia).
- *Goniothalamus wynaadensis*, endemic to India's Western Ghats with limited distribution, is also assessed NT, threatened by habitat fragmentation (Wikipedia).
- **Data Deficient (DD)** entries often involve lesser-studied or narrow-range taxa such as aquatic **Charophyta** algae or *Isoetes* quillworts—reflecting gaps in data rather than lack of threat (Wikipedia).

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